Michael E. Stiso

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By training, I'm a cognitive psychologist. By practice, I'm both an applied researcher and a UXer.

I tend to focus on decision-support tools for professionals working in complex, high-stakes environments, but I have worked on many kinds of products.

SUMMARY

Current position UX Lead at 4Subsea, providing decision support for offshore energy.

Education Doctorate in cognitive psychology. My graduate training was in human mental capabilities and limitations, with a focus on learning and decision making. It continues to shape how I approach both research and design.

Work experience Over 15 years in user-centered design, working in areas such as crisis management, aviation, agriculture, banking, the military, energy, enterprise solutions, and telecommunications. My experience has been primarily in small teams, letting me perform both user research and interface design. Research shapes what gets designed; design raises new research questions.

Specialty The thread connecting my work is a passion for building decision-support tools for professionals in dynamic environments where choices carry real consequences, and I have pursued both in research labs and in commercial settings.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

UX Lead & Product Designer
2023 – Present
4Subsea
Asker, Norway

Sole UX practitioner for a digital solutions platform serving the offshore energy sector. Adopted and refined the company's first design system, led a platform-wide usability redesign, and expanded user research across product teams.

UX Lead
2019 – 2023
DNV
Høvik, Norway

Multiple roles across a large professional-services organization undergoing digital transformation: UX evangelism, innovation strategy, information visualization, and research and design across teams and products.

Experience Designer
2016 – 2019
Yara International
Oslo, Norway

Research and design for precision-farming tools across augmented reality (HoloLens), mobile, web, and chatbots. Helped develop an experience-design strategy aligning user needs with business goals.

Innovation Experimentation Lead
2015 – 2016
Nordea
Oslo, Norway

Designed fast-and-frugal experiments to assess new financial-product concepts. Qualitative and quantitative research, UX consulting, and engagement with the Scandinavian startup ecosystem.

HCI Researcher
2008 – 2015
SINTEF ICT
Oslo, Norway

Established a “decision support in complex environments” research area. Led two EU-funded crisis-management projects and the successful bid for SINTEF's role in the EU SESAR air-traffic-management programme.

Senior Usability Engineer
2005 – 2008
Oracle
Redwood Shores, CA, USA

Iterative usability testing on enterprise software, and interaction widgets of my own design — two patented, one adopted organization-wide.

Human-Systems Engineer
2003 – 2005
CHI Systems
Orlando, FL, USA

Military training and decision-support systems. Cognitive task analyses of military specialists. Investigation of the use of videogames in military training.

INTERNSHIPS

Human-factors placements during graduate school: usability testing and expert evaluations, from a battleship ordnance console to websites, phones, and voice-response systems, with prototyped redesigns that tested better than the originals. Also studied how crews planning unmanned aerial vehicle flights make decisions.

Naval Research Intern
Space and Naval Warfare Systems Command

2002 / San Diego, CA, USA

Human-Factors Intern
SBC Laboratories
(telecommunications)

2000 / Austin, TX, USA

Human-Factors Intern
Air Force Office of Scientific Research

1998, San Antonio, TX, USA

EDUCATION

Doctor of Philosophy
Cognitive Psychology

Texas A&M University
College Station, TX

August 2003

Master of Science
Cognitive Psychology

University of Oregon
Eugene, OR

Bachelor of Arts
Psychology
Minors: *English*, *Anthropology*

Purdue University
West Lafayette, IN

AWARDS

NASA Graduate Student Researchers Fellowship

Marshall Space Flight Center
August 2002 – August 2003

Air Force Office of Scientific Research Graduate Fellowship

Brooks Air Force Base
June 1998 – August 1998